

IsHaunted — The visitor

Somebody with no account, who arrived from a search or a link. Written for a developer joining the project.

Every screenshot shows simulated, seeded data, captured in dark mode while signed in as this user type. Nothing here is a real person, case or investigation. Where a page shows a refusal, that is the designed behaviour for this seat.

The visitor is the largest audience and the one with the least patience. Everything they can reach is public on purpose: the site's whole growth argument is that somebody researching a haunted address finds a real archive rather than a sign-up wall.

What they can do: read the feed, browse public places and their archives, find groups near them, read published investigations, and ask a group for help. What they cannot do is anything tied to an identity — which is where the refusals below come from.

How this site decides what you may see

Two things gate every surface, and they are different questions:

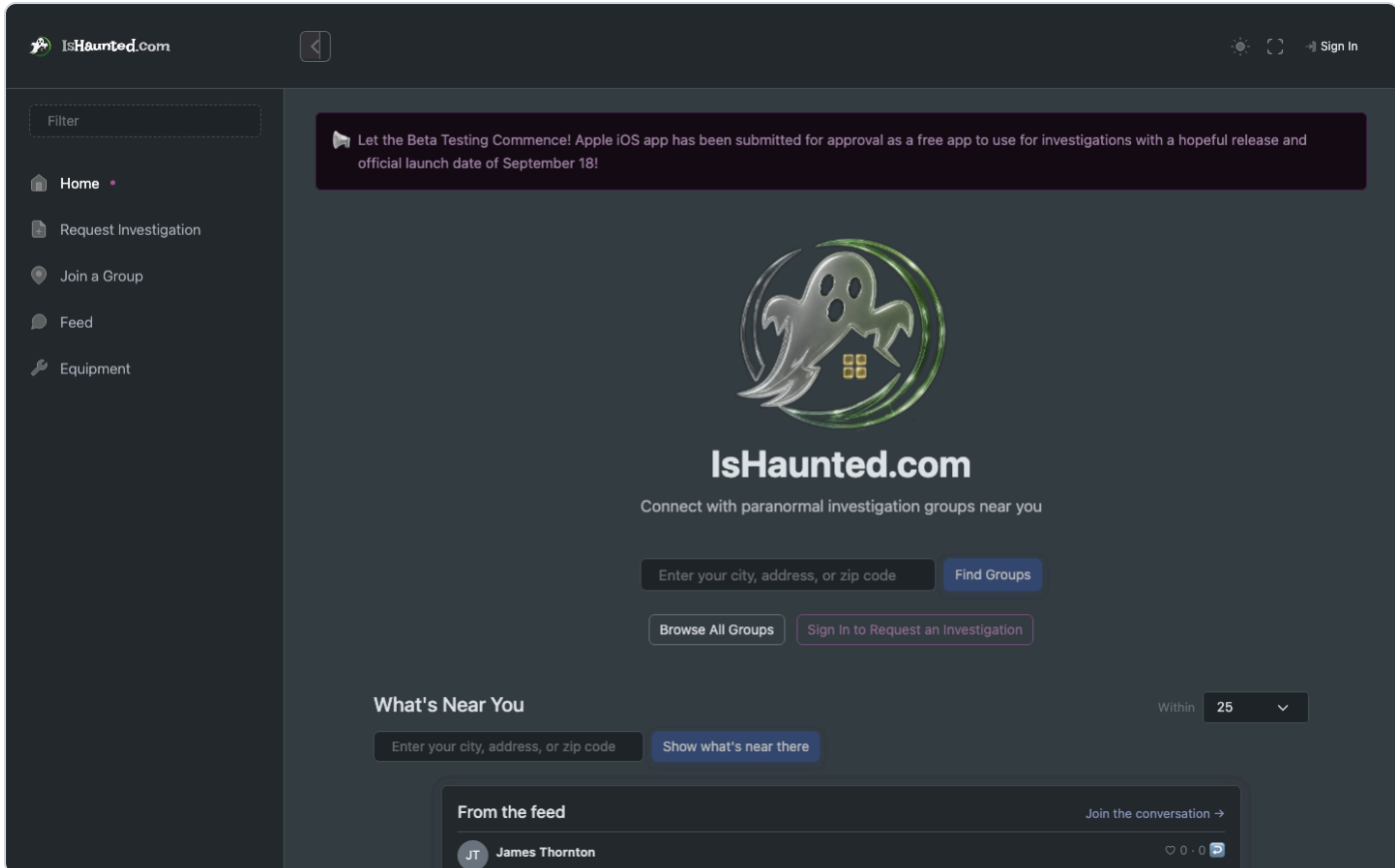
Your seat in a group — owner, administrator, member, viewer — answers "may this person do this?". **The group's plan** answers "does this group pay for this at all?". A member of a group whose plan excludes an area is refused for a completely different reason than a viewer who is not allowed to write, and the site says which.

A refusal is never rendered as "nothing here." An empty list and a server saying no are different facts, and a page that shows the same grey nothing for both teaches people to distrust it. Every list goes through `LoadResult`, which carries loading, empty, refused, session-ended and rate-limited as distinct states — and every one of them has its own words on screen.

This matters when reading this document: where a screenshot shows a refusal, that *is* the designed behaviour for this seat, not a broken page.

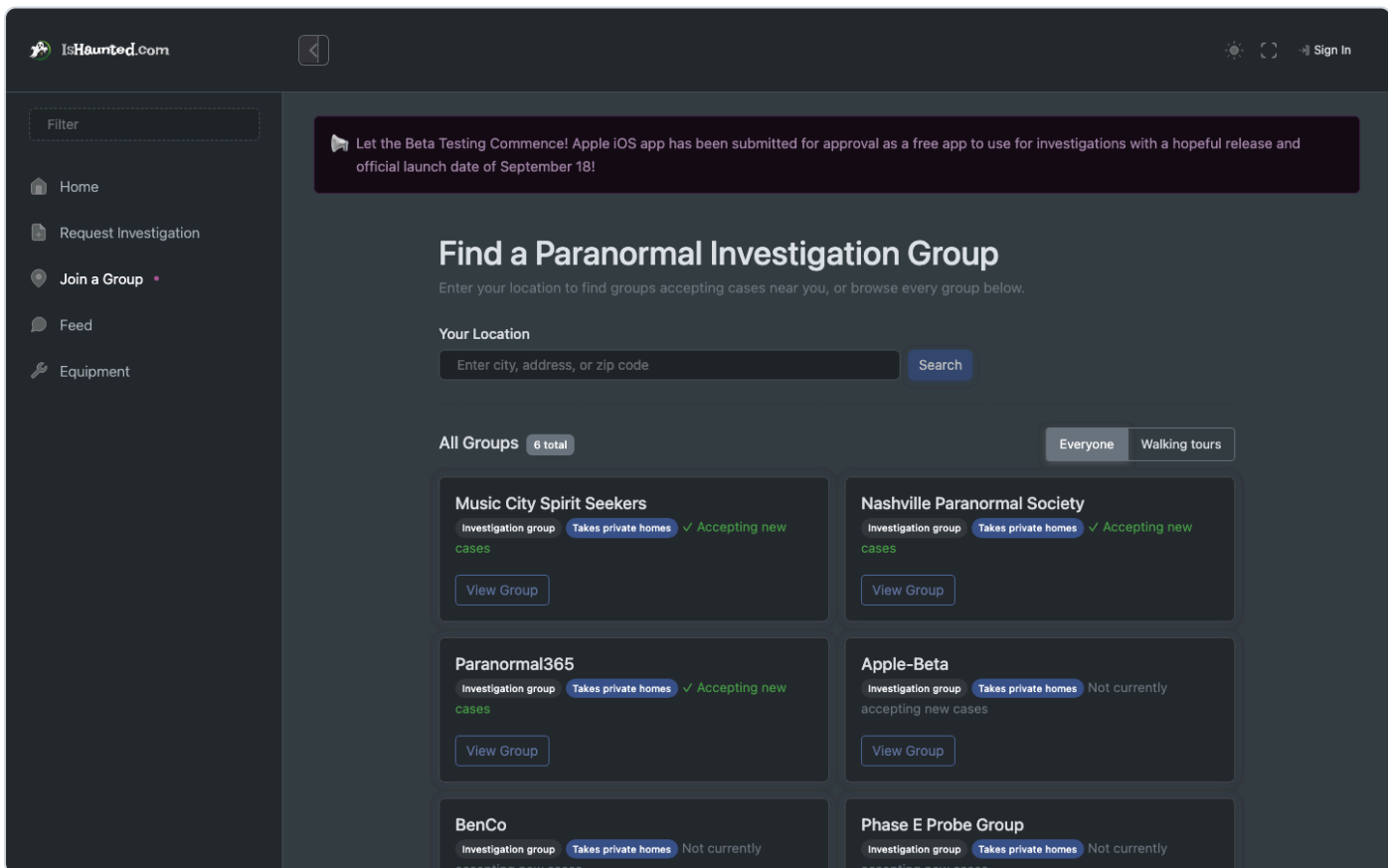
What this user sees, screen by screen

Home. The front door. Search by place, and what is near you.



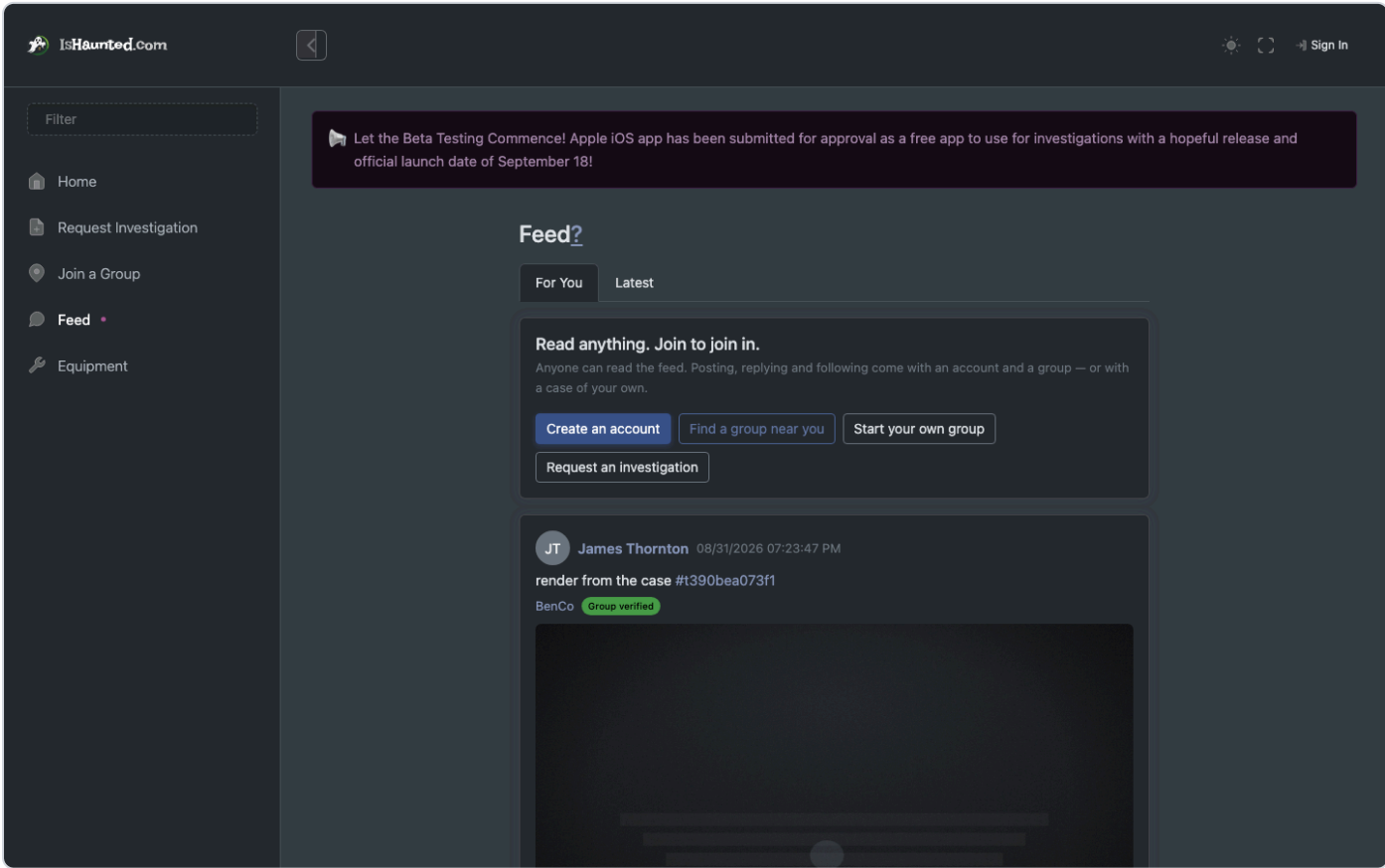
Home

Find groups. Groups a person can approach, with what each one covers.



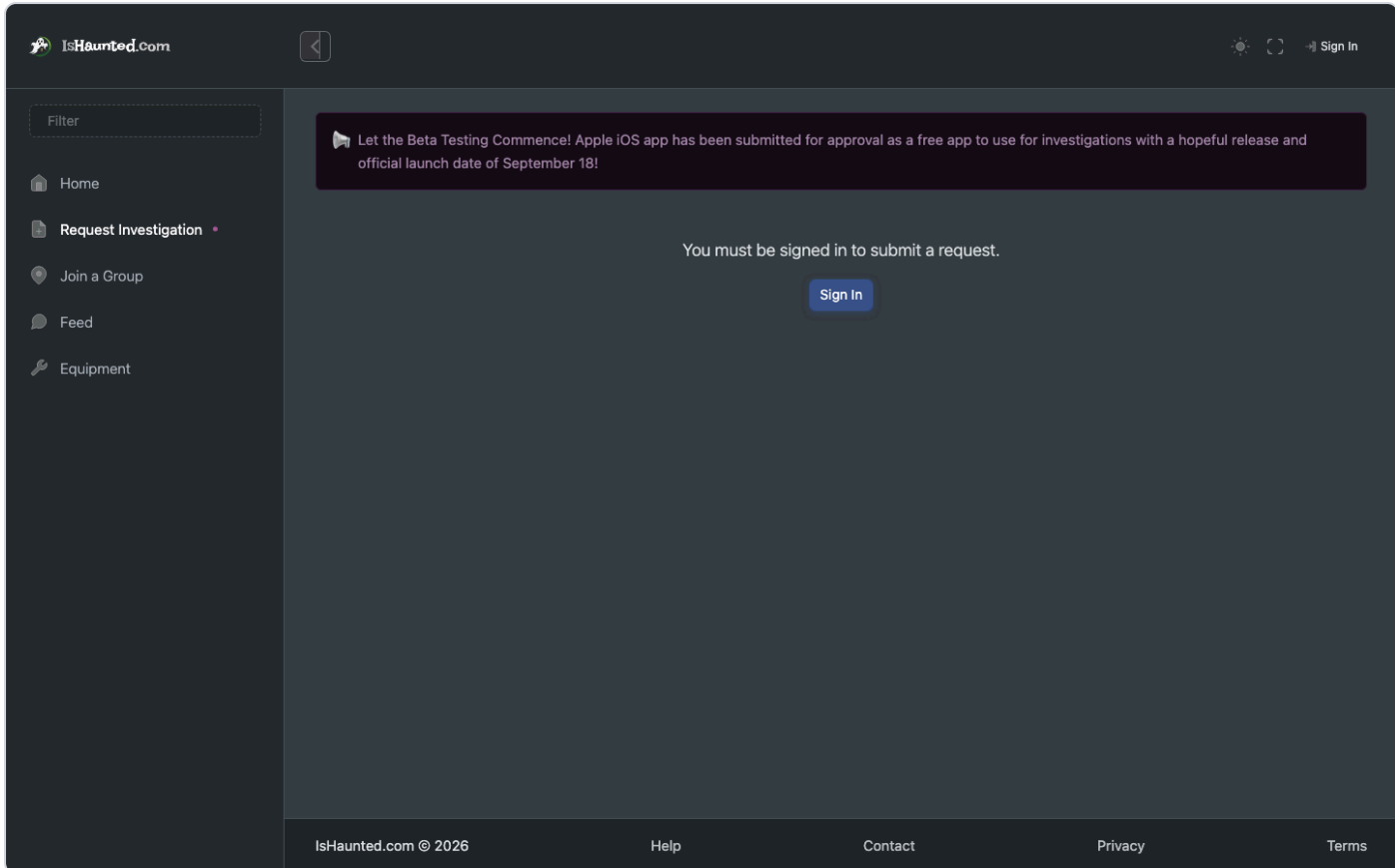
Find groups

Feed. The public feed. Reading is open to everyone; posting is not.



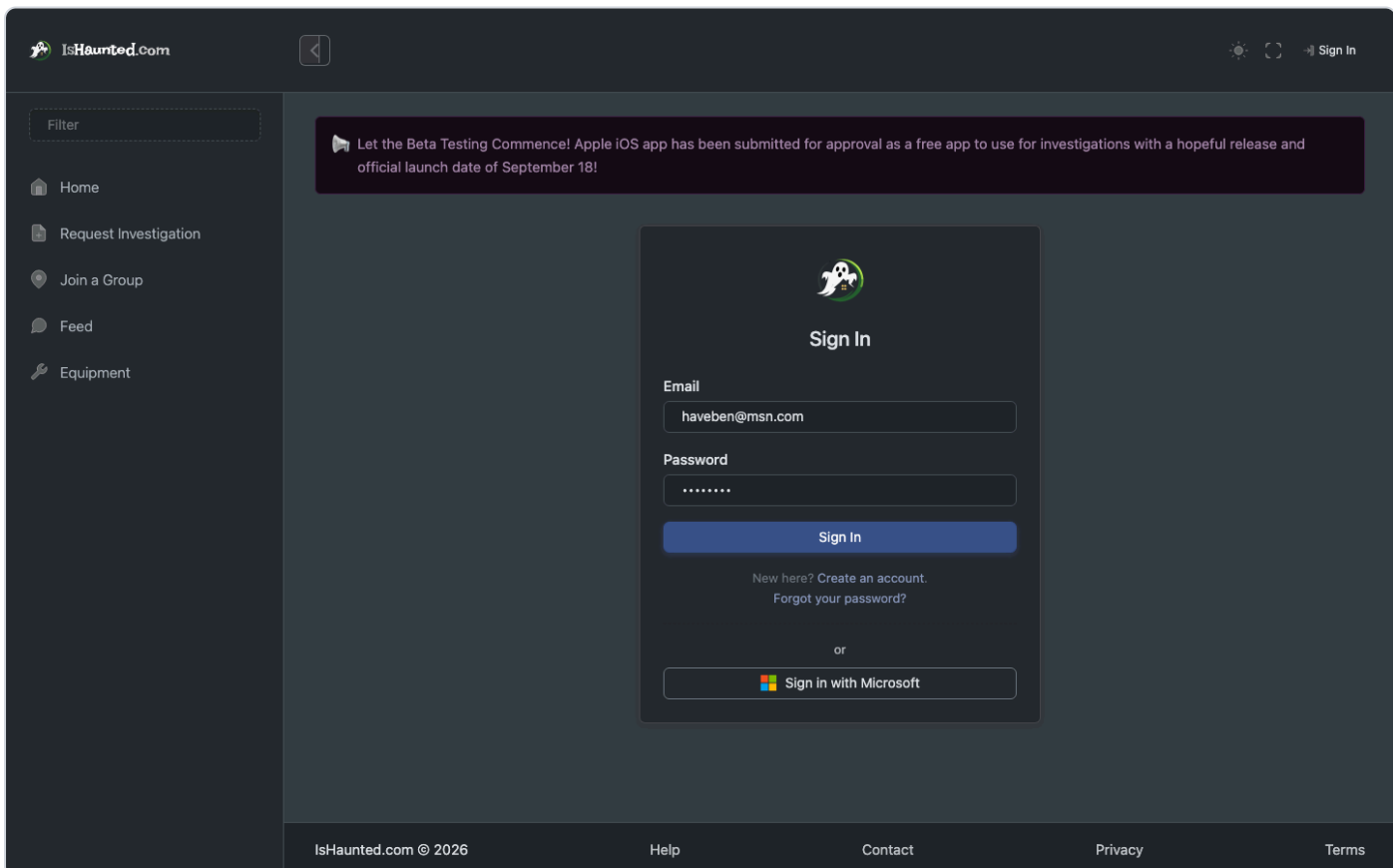
Feed

Request an investigation. The request flow — the main conversion path on the site.



Request an investigation

Sign in. Sign in, including Microsoft and Apple.



Sign in

Sign up. Registration. The @name is permanent and the form says so.

IsHaunted.com

Sign In

Filter

Home

Request Investigation

Join a Group

Feed

Equipment

Let the Beta Testing Commence! Apple iOS app has been submitted for approval as a free app to use for investigations with a hopeful release and official launch date of September 18!

Create an account?

Already have one? Sign in.

First name

Last name

Sarah

Mitchell

Display name

Sarah Mitchell

What people see on your posts and your profile. You can change this later.

Your @name

@ sarahmitchell

How people mention you — @yourname . Letters, numbers and underscores. This cannot be changed later.

Email

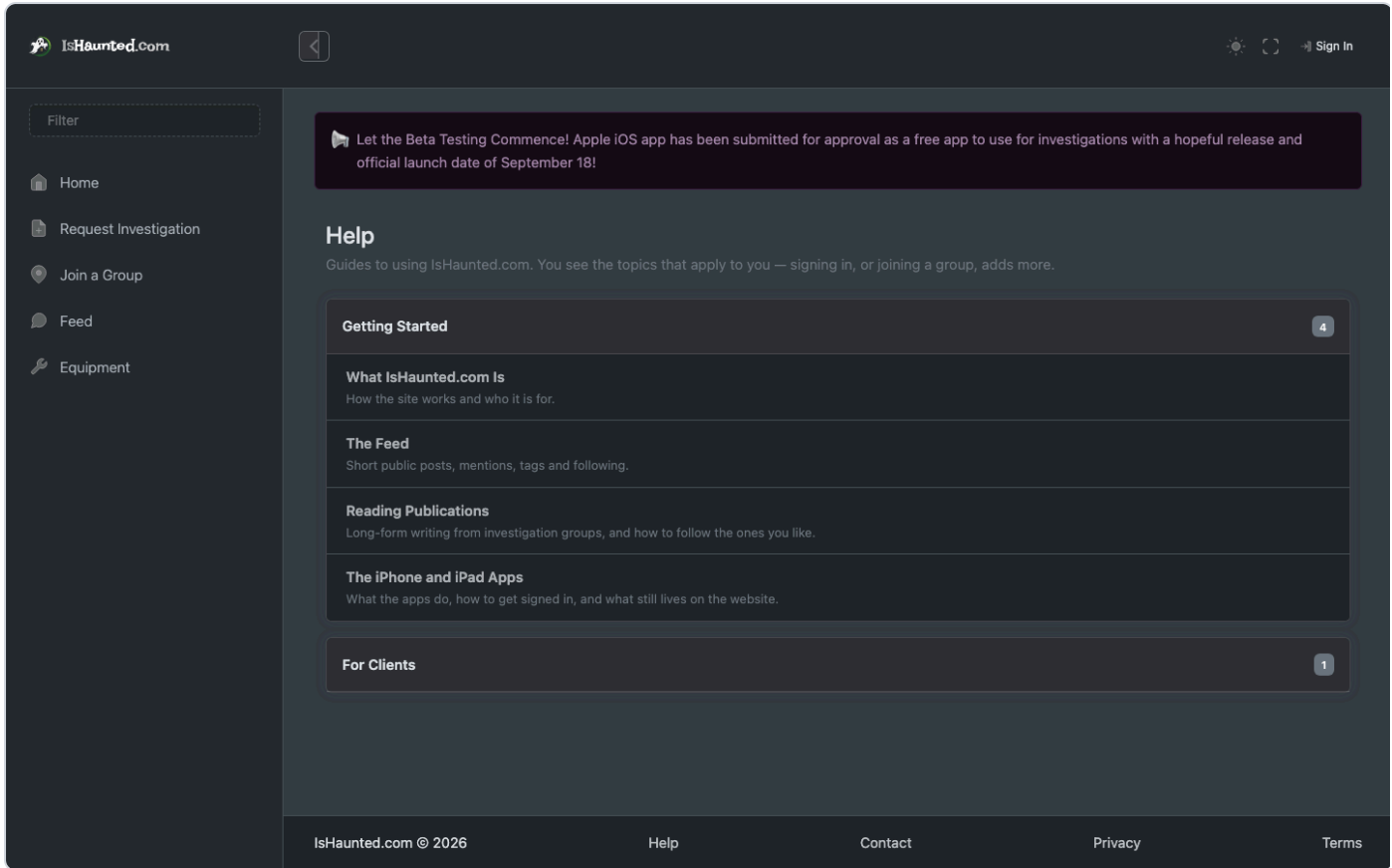
We'll send a link to confirm it. You can't sign in until you have.

Password

At least 8 characters, with an upper-case letter, a lower-case letter and a digit.

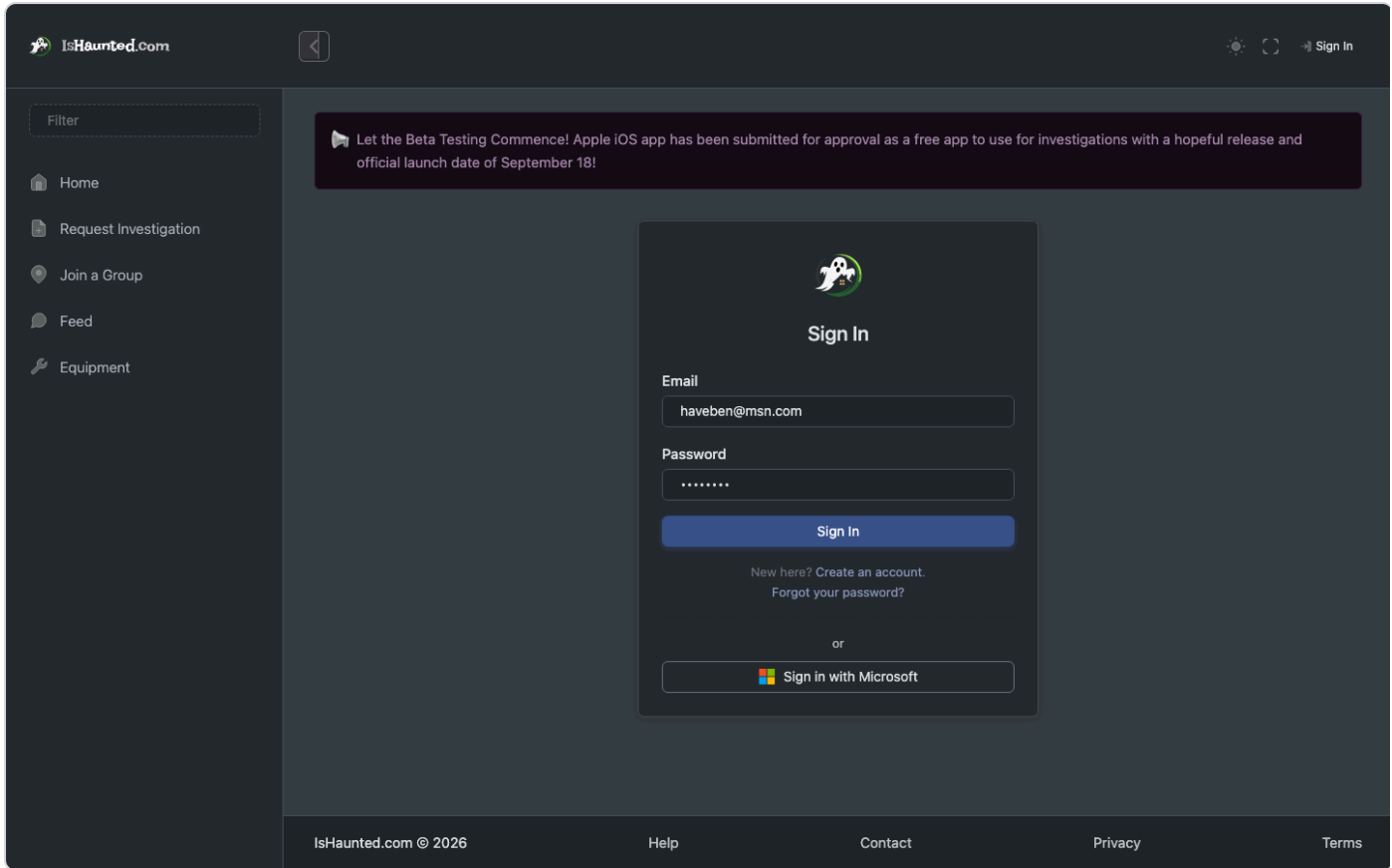
Sign up

Help. The in-app help, readable without an account.



Help

Refused my cases. A page that needs an account. Note it explains rather than showing an empty list — this is the refusal rule in action.



Refused my cases